Surgical Safety Checklist — Quick Reference

Study notes — Perioperative Theatre Safety unit. A condensed reference based on the WHO three-phase surgical safety checklist framework.

Phase 1 — Sign In (before anaesthesia)

- Patient identity, site, procedure, and consent confirmed
- Surgical site marked (or marking not applicable)
- Anaesthesia safety check completed
- Pulse oximeter on patient and functioning
- Known allergies reviewed
- Difficult airway or aspiration risk assessed, equipment/assistance available
- Risk of >500ml blood loss assessed, IV access and fluids planned

Phase 2 — Time Out (before skin incision)

- All team members introduced by name and role
- Patient, site, and procedure confirmed aloud by the team
- Anticipated critical events reviewed (surgeon, anaesthetist, nursing team)
- Antibiotic prophylaxis given in the last 60 minutes (or not applicable)
- Essential imaging displayed, if needed

Phase 3 — Sign Out (before patient leaves theatre)

- Procedure name recorded as performed
- Instrument, sponge, and needle counts confirmed correct
- Specimens labelled correctly, including patient name
- Equipment problems identified and flagged for follow-up
- Key concerns for recovery and management reviewed aloud

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